

MAINS MASTER PROGRAM (MMP) 2024

ETHICS -11

GS-IV : Ethics, Integrity & Aptitude

Case Study II

Case study #6

Mr. A is a good friend of yours. You know him to be a socially responsible human being. He heads an NGO that works in the field of environment conservation and protection. He has been working with dedication for the cause for last 8 years.

However, for last few months, the NGO is in dire need of funds for operations and payments to the staff. All the funds are exhausted and no new project funds are in sight. In this situation, he is approached by a large infrastructure company, *Company X*, which is ready to provide a huge amount of money, under company's CSR, to fund all the projects his NGO is planning.

However, as a *quid pro quo*, the *Company X* is asking him to raise objections over an ongoing PPP project. This project is being implemented by *Company X*'s rival company. These kinds of projects are generally known to have bypassed norms of Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA). *Mr. A* too knows that there have been instances of high-level corruption in the process of granting EIA to many other PPP mega projects like this one. Hence, he decides to accept the money and agrees to raise the objection. His NGO, being a credible voice for environment protection, raising objection against any mega project will significantly stall the implementation of the mega project.

- Considering the circumstances of the case, evaluate ethically the decision of your friend.
- If you were in place of *Mr. A*, what would have been your course of action? Give reasons for it.

Fact of the case –

1. My friend - Dedicated social worker
2. Dire need of fund for his NGO
3. Company –X offers funds but expects quid-pro-quo
4. Wants him to fight against Rival company – mega project possible corruption
5. Only possibility no surity
6. Mega project stalling = big cost to exchequere
7. He agrees the deal

Stake holders –

1. Friend NGO
2. Company X
3. Company Y
4. Government official
5. Mega projects
6. Environment

Values involved –

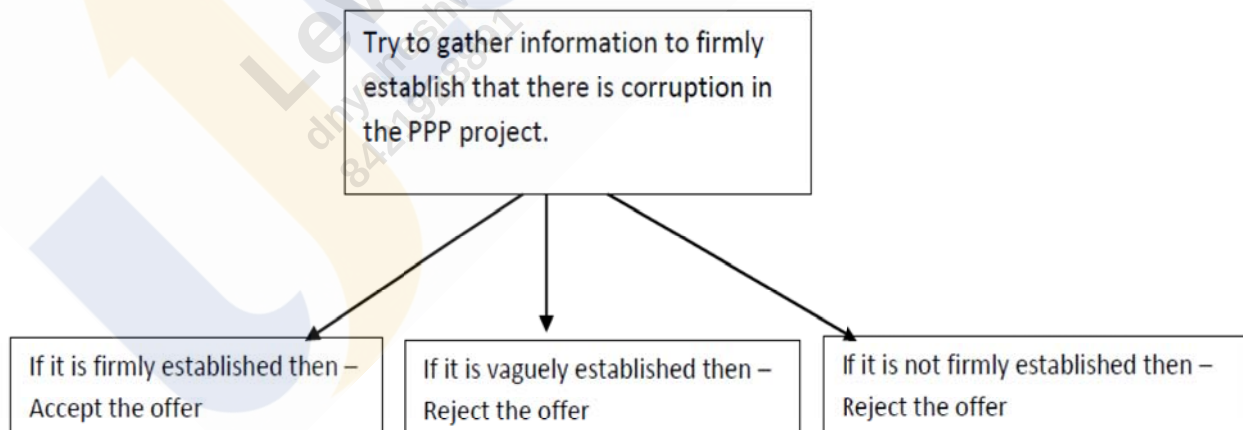
1. Responsibility/Leadership towards own NGO
2. Integrity
3. Environment friendliness
4. Fortitude

1. Ethical analysis -

- decision on the basis of his past knowledge about corruption in PPP projects – but no confirmation
- His organization works on environmental conservation.
- His responsibility towards staff
- Company X – using this opportunity for their vested interest against its rival.
- He had 2 options -
 1. To reject the offer
 2. To accept the offer.

- He accepting the offer.
- Compromising objectivity and impartiality.
- he is not being rational enough
- even if it turns out to be true in future his decision to oppose it now is biased and self-motivated.
- Upholds responsibility, stewardship wrt staff and NGO – environment
- If no corruption - detrimental to larger public interest- narrow view
- if allegations true - intentions not fully noble and broad (Compromising the means to support an ethical end)
- I think his decision is compromising basic tenets of ethics.

My possible Course of action –



1. If established - anyway raise voice against – it will help future PPP - also aid finding issues in EIA
2. If not established - cannot accept offer- otherwise dishonesty - large scale disruption in the implantation - people lose trust - hamper welfare efforts.
3. Request company X to investigate - till then X can fund NGO
4. If company X is not ready - continue looking for sources – staff and environment concerns

Case study #7

Since recent past, there have been huge migration of youth from rural areas to urban areas in search of better economic opportunities. As a consequence of this, their parents, senior citizens, mostly farmers, are compelled to live alone in the villages. Without support of their children, when they need it the most, these senior citizens are facing difficulties not just on economic front but also on social, emotional etc.

- 1. Analyse the different aspects involved in the issue.**
- 2. Suggest strategy to tackle the problem.**

Understand the issue:

Rural areas in India are the ones where most of Indians stay. Almost all of them are farmers. The above case study reflects on the unfortunate plight- emotional, social and economic- of the senior citizens, especially residing in rural areas.

Values involved -

1. Empathy and Compassion – to be able to understand the plight of senior citizen
2. Dignity of them
3. Respect from society

Analysis :

1. The major reason - economic
2. Rural - dependent on the farming
3. Traditional norms - direct responsibility of the younger generation – economically but also socially and emotionally.

Economic reasons –

1. In recent past - opportunities shrinking –population increasing - Forcing migration to urban areas.
2. Farming itself is in distress.
3. Shift was too sudden to adjust

Social reasons –

1. Family structures - also changing -nuclear family –
2. place of elders diminishing - in the want of due respect and dignity.

Personal reasons -

1. city life - unimaginably fast - senior citizen finding difficult to live

2. Strategy :

Economic –

1. Enhance economic opportunities in rural areas.
2. farming activities - priority in economic policies
3. E.g. - water, credit and market.
4. Modern technology - in farming – so that senior citizen can contribute
5. industry opportunities for youth staying in rural area
6. Infrastructure in rural areas must be improved on the lines of PURA.

Social –

1. greater awareness among the youth about taking parents responsibility.
2. Through emotional appeals in public, advertisements etc.
3. In some cases law – e.g. MH govt
4. The curriculum in schools - more relevant

Personal –

1. The requisite infrastructure for health facilities - especially mental health
2. psychological consultation facilities to younger generation

Case study #8

You are responsible for a performance audit of defence preparedness of your country. This involves detailed auditing of the Ministry of Defence and its all wings. After the year-long audit exercise by your department, you receive the draft report.

When you read the report, you realised that the findings include a lot of data indicating lacunas in the defence preparedness. If this data goes public, it may jeopardize the country's image as a strong nation in the international arena. This will put the nation's security in danger. Meanwhile, you receive a call from the concerned ministry to drop those findings, which otherwise may lead to the weakening of the nation's deterrence.

- a) In such a situation, what options do you have?**
- b) After analysing each option, choose one giving its justification.**

Fact of the case –

1. I am responsible for a performance audit of defence preparedness
2. involves detailed auditing of the Ministry of Defence and its all wings.
3. findings include a lot of data indicating lacunas in the defence preparedness.
4. If public, it may jeopardize the country's image
5. This will put the nation's security in danger
6. I receive a call from the concerned ministry to drop those findings

Dilemma in front of me:

1. true and honest audit Vs country's deterrence
2. auditor = a friend philosopher guide
3. On other hand = responsibility of the auditor to bring out unpleasant but honest facts about govt performance.

Values involved –

1. Duty
2. Objectivity and rationality
3. Fortitude
4. National good

Options	Merit	Demerit
Option-1 – Keeping all data	1. Honest reporting 2. Help improve defence preparedness 3. My duty is to report rest leave it to parliament to decide	1. May bring out negative consequences harming nation's image 2. To mechanistic without consideration to practical issue
Option-2 – Removing as per minister	1. Acting as friend philosopher guide and not as an obstructer 2. Savig county's image and also deterrence, which is the very reason why we have armies 3. Avoiding contravercies	1. Overlooking the chances of minister's vested interests 2. Not applying your own understanding is running away from duties
Option-3 - Removing as my discretion	1. Taking the responsibility 2. Collecting further information to decide indicates scientific temper 3. Shows concern for one's own nation indicating patriotism	1. Risking to go wrong as capacity of one is always limited 2. Still problematic data may remain and crate problem if goes public
Option-4 – Discuss this issue within audit dept	1. Consulting with larger group will bring in more inputs making decision more democratic 2. Within department consultation will bring coherence in decision as it would be considered as one voice. 3. Concerns of nation's deterrence image can be talked more effectively	1. It may be time consuming 2. More confusion may get created making it difficult to decide 3. Shows lack of responsibility

Analysis of options –

1. Deontological – go as per duty don't worry about consequence
2. consequentialism – ends important while taking decision
3. report once submitted - no control
4. Situation demand further deliberations, perhaps with experts

Option-4 chosen –

1. It helps me being in more inputs.
2. seek guidance from seniors as the issue is very sensitive.
3. larger group = defendability of the decision increases.
4. issue at hand is very complex and sensitive = inputs from some experts in my department.
5. coherent decision from audit department - improveing its say in parliament

Case study #9

Rajanna, a farmer, mostly grew sugar-cane on his acres of land. Some time back, he bought a tractor from the money he borrowed from a private bank, as loan. He used a part of the money to pay dowry and expenses for his daughter's wedding.

Owing to the price drop of sugar cane in the market, he consistently defaulted on his bank loan. Fortunately, he owned irrigated land, so he was confident of repaying the debt within two years. However, the region experienced drought for the next three years. As a result, he could not grow any crop and hence could not generate any revenue. He sent his two sons to Bangalore to work as construction workers. But they too could not save enough, as living costs in Bangalore were very high compared to their income.

Bank authorities have sent him repeated notices. Rajanna and many others in the village are hoping for waiver of their loans by the government, but the government is somehow not inclined to waive their loans. After waiting for many months, he decides to end his life. But he is worried about his wife's future and wants her too to commit suicide with him.

His wife narrates the situation to you. You are a member of an NGO working on the water issues and farmers' suicide problems.

- a) Analyse the above situation bringing out different ethical aspects involved in it.
- b) What will be your course of action?

Fact of the case -

1. bought a tractor from the loan from private bank
2. used a part of the money - dowry and daughter's wedding.
3. price drop of sugar cane in the market - consistently defaulted
4. region experienced drought for the next three years.
5. two sons to Bangalore - construction workers – no help
6. Bank authorities have sent him repeated notices.
7. Waiting for waiver - but govt not ready
8. he decides to end his life.
9. wants wife too to commit suicide with him.
10. His wife narrates the situation to you.
11. I am a member of an NGO working on the water issues and farmers' suicide problems.

a) Analysis –

1. The case brings out many different aspects of human suffering.
2. Non inclusive economy- economic model to be exploitative and unethical.
3. Farming as economic activity in danger
4. Negative impact of globalization on farming
5. Inadequate government capacity
6. Emotional turmoil
7. Lack of employment opportunities even in big cities
8. added to their relocation away from their parents
9. Evil tradition of dowry

b) Course of action -

1. The most important and urgent - support the family emotionally - bringing out from depression
2. Its my professional duty too - in addition to moral one
3. My major objective - to help him economically.
4. Talks to family- friends-relatives
5. try to mobilise some money from this group
6. I will also meet the concerned bank officers expressing them about his situation
7. I will also contact with local agriculture department – KVK or ATMA
8. I will also forward the case to concerned person in my organization for any assistance they can give.
9. I will propose to my NGO to start farmers helpline for other such distressed farmers.

Case study #10

It is generally seen that any move from the government aiming fundamental social change faces public apathy and even active opposition at times. Same could be seen in the case of the ambitious scheme of *Bati Bachao Beti Padhao*. The scheme aims, not only to stop female foeticide and improve their school enrolment but also overall empowerment of women in the society.

- a) Bring out the challenges in implementing the scheme.
- b) How, as a district magistrate, will you use persuasion as a tool to improve the implementation of the scheme in your district?

Fact of the case

1. generally seen - move from the government aiming fundamental social change - public apathy and even active opposition at times.
2. Same with *Bati Bachao Beti Padhao*.
3. The scheme –
 - i. stop female foeticide
 - ii. improve school enrolment
 - iii. overall empowerment of women

Understanding the issue –

1. depicts peoples' negative attitudes towards long term social change.
2. happens due to lack of awareness
3. ability to question the tradition.
4. Persuasion is needed

Challenges –

1. The biggest challenge = attitude of the people dictated by traditional beliefs.
2. Inferior - liability and not an asset.
3. excessive importance to those earning money in the family
4. Tradition can never be wrong - women are never meant to be educated and sent out of the home
5. Safety and security concerns –concern of parents of girls.
6. Dowry

Persuasion as tool –

1. Solution = attitude change - tool = persuasion.
2. Awareness campaigns – People made aware about unscientific thinking behind not questioning traditions.
3. The dedicated campaign to make people aware about their unethical behaviors with respect to women.
4. appealed through positive examples of successful and educated women
5. International women day will be celebration – BBBP connected
6. Rewards and recognitions – special awards will be set up to recognize successful women from all walks of life.
7. Advertisements thorough posters and flyers
8. Eye catching Programmed like ‘Selfie with daughter’ on social media.
9. Safety and security of girl/women
10. adequate intake of women police personnel.
11. Incentivisation – The entry of women to schools will be incentivized by providing them bicycles, free bus passes etc.

Home Work - Practice Questions

Practice Case Study – 1

You are the district magistrate of a district in a north-eastern state of India. The state is amongst the greenest in India. It is clad with Himalayan mountain ranges with very diverse flora and fauna. The district saw a disturbing development. Farmers there have started tomato cultivation in the river valleys. In fact, the cultivation are encroaching upon the mountain slopes, destroying the ecologically precious forests. Heavy pesticides and fertilizers are reportedly being used to cultivate the tomato crop. Residues of pesticides and other agricultural chemicals eventually drain into the river, decimating the aquatic life and valuable fish such as the snow trout endemic to the region.

Due to increase in such cultivation the district is running short of laborers, so cultivators are forced to import labourers from other States. This migration of labour into Arunachal Pradesh is likely to affect the culture of the mountain people and even lead to poaching of wildlife because of the immigrants' lack of awareness of the mountain ecology. Steps are urgently needed to prevent the degradation of ecology and protect the indigenous culture.

However cultivators are getting good returns through this crop as compared to their traditional alternatives. This also gets trickled down to everyone engaged in the cultivation viz- labourers, transporters etc. As a result locals are happy about the cultivation, as alternatively they see very less economic opportunities.

Analyse the situation and propose a roadmap to tackle it.

(250 Words, 20)

Practice Case Study – 2

You are a District Magistrate of a district where the spread of COVID-19 has been decreasing after an unfortunate spell of huge number of cases and deaths. As a preventive measure, a strict lockdown has been there in the district for more than 8 months. This has resulted substantial suppression of economic activity in the district and the livelihood of common public is at stake. The demand for lifting of restrictions is increasing and people are losing all their patience. There have also been reports of 2-3 instances of suicide by those who have lost their source of livelihood due to the lockdown for a long time. However, as per the experts suggest, lifting of lockdown without complete immunization of population may result in recurring of serious situation as it was 8 months back. Central and state government, along with scientist and pharma companies, have been putting a lot of efforts in making the vaccines available in enough quantity. As a result the availability of vaccine has been satisfactory in your district. However there is a huge hesitancy among masses about vaccine. Following are some of the misconceptions people hold resulting vaccine hesitancy:

- i. Cases are decreasing anyway and COVID will automatically go away
- ii. None of the vaccine has 100% efficacy
- iii. Vaccines are made in hurry so its risky
- iv. Vaccine causes infertility among youngsters
- v. Taking vaccine is against our religious beliefs
- vi. Those who have taken vaccine are also getting infected by COVID-19

In this situation,

- a) Mention different issues needing your intervention.
 - b) What would be your response to each of the issues, with special focus of IEC (Information, Education, Communication) efforts
- (250 Words, 20)

Practice Case Study – 3

You are recently posted as the head of a government office in a state. You are leading a team of four officers and none of you originally belong to this state. There are around two hundred people working as staff in the office in various capacities and most of them are local people. This specific state is notorious for lack of professionalism, poor law & order and there are elements of feudalistic attitude prevailing among the locals.

Upon joining, you notice that there is a lot of inefficiency in overall operation and that the attitude of the staff is generally lackadaisical and careless about the work. When you probe it further, you realise that most of the staff is irregular to the office. They often come late, sign on attendance register, and vanish. Some of them even have their own private businesses. They return in the evening only to sign on the attendance register again and then go home. Due to such state of affairs, the office work is seriously jeopardized.

To remedy the situation, you have now installed biometric attendance system in your office. However, your staff is resisting this move by refusing to use it. One day, the staff starts protesting and then threatens with strike, demanding the removal of the biometric system. They all seem united and strong. The fact that your team is composed only of outsiders gives them extra courage to unite and defy your authority.

- a) Briefly summerise the situation in your own words, focusing on the challenges in front of you.
- b) In this situation, what plan of action will you follow? (20 Marks)